Adjuvant abemaciclib + endocrine therapy

Abemaciclib is taken twice daily continuously, with endocrine treatment, for up to two years if appropriate. A 28-day block is shown for orientation; there is no planned tablet-free week. Endocrine treatment usually continues longer.

Draft — independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hair / scalp

Whole treatment plan

Tell the team about changes affecting wellbeing or daily life.

3 Breathing

CDK4/6 treatment

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment.

5 Bowel

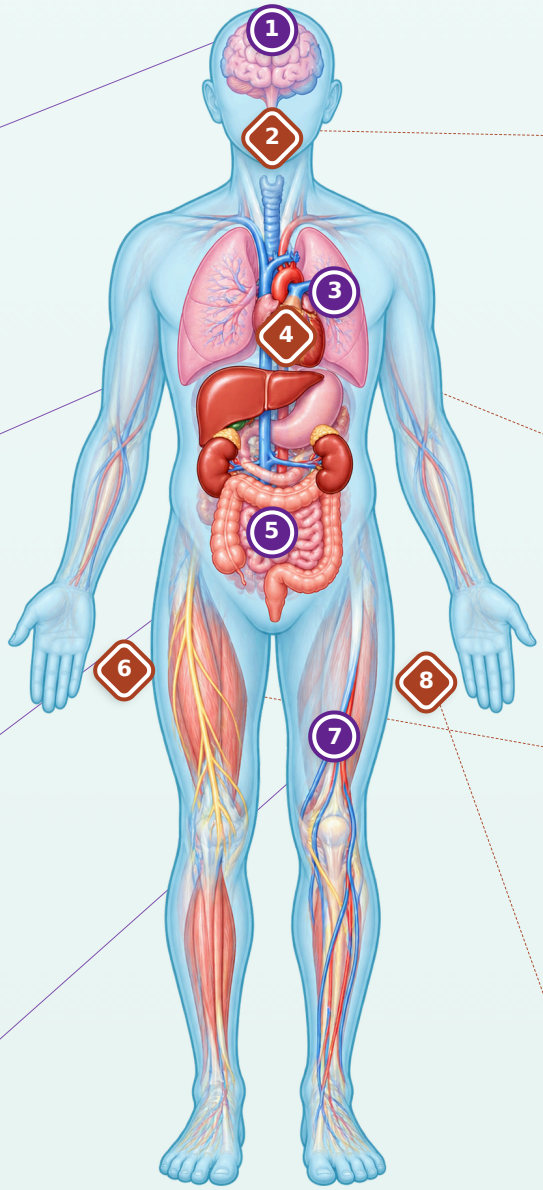
Abemaciclib

Report diarrhoea early, especially with poor fluid intake, pain or fever.

7 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy / CDK4/6

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately.



2 Mouth

Treatment symptoms

Painful ulcers or difficulty eating and drinking need advice.

4 Heart / circulation

Clot symptoms

A painful swollen leg or new chest/breathing symptoms may indicate a clot; seek prompt help.

6 Nerves / joints

Endocrine treatment

Report lasting numbness, painful joints or difficulty with daily activities.

8 Skin / liver symptoms

Treatment medicines

Severe rash, blistering or yellow skin/eyes needs prompt advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

NCCP 00619 · PRACTICAL SUPPORT

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Abemaciclib

- Diarrhoea, dehydration and nausea
- Low blood counts and infection
- Liver-test abnormalities
- Blood clots
- Rare serious lung inflammation

Your endocrine treatment

- Hot flushes, joint or muscle symptoms
- Vaginal dryness and sexual effects
- Bone loss with AI / ovarian suppression
- Clot and uterine risks with tamoxifen

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Diarrhoea plan

Have the prescribed antidiarrhoeal medicine available. Start the agreed plan at the first loose stool and call early.

Daily tablets

Take the prescribed dose at regular times. Do not double up after a missed or vomited dose.

Bloods and interactions

Keep early blood-test appointments. Check every new medicine or supplement with oncology/pharmacy; avoid grapefruit.

Endocrine and bone care

Confirm endocrine/OFS treatment, bone-health assessment and the longer-term follow-up plan.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00619/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.